

The Guest of Honor

LEAD DETECTIVE

“Everyone came to celebrate you. Now they need you to solve a mystery.”



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

GUEST OF HONOR · LEAD DETECTIVE

WHAT TO WEAR

Dress style: wear something blue: a blue dress, a blue scarf or blue earrings.

Suit style: wear something blue: a blue tie, a blue pocket square or a blue suit.

At the party you are: the person this whole weekend celebrates, and tonight, the Lead Detective.

Who you know: Cece Marchbanks was planning your wedding. Blair Ashdown is your best friend and Person of Honor. You hired Reese Calloway for the cake and chose Bluebell Lake Inn, run by Emerson Pryce. Cece brought photographer Finley Marsh and florist Dakota Lane.

How this booklet works

-  **Before guests arrive:** read page 2 alone: your afternoon and your detective privileges.
-  **Something Old · Round 1:** open page 3 and read Evidence #4 aloud.
-  **Something New · Round 2:** the lower half of page 3, and Evidence #8.
-  **Something Borrowed · Round 3:** page 4, Evidence #12, then your Final Questions.
-  **Something Blue · the reveal:** you open file 99 and read the truth aloud.

Print this booklet single-sided (or cut along the dashed line on page 3), so later rounds can't show through.

◆ THE WEEKEND ◆

A celebration weekend at Bluebell Lake Inn. At the welcome tea, celebrated wedding planner Celestine “Cece” Marchbanks sipped from the Guest of Honor’s heirloom blue teacup, went upstairs to rest and never woke up. Everyone at this party had a reason to be at that tea.

Keep this booklet to yourself. Ask boldly, listen closely and enjoy your night.

You are not the culprit and you are not in danger.

You are the Lead Detective. Nothing in this booklet is a trick.

You and Cece

Cece Marchbanks was planning your wedding. Your family booked Cece a year ago: the most famous planner on the lake, brilliant, bossy and booked solid. You loved Cece's ideas and dreaded Cece's 6 a.m. emails. You chose Bluebell Lake Inn for this celebration weekend, and you hired Reese Calloway for the cake even though Cece tried to talk you out of it.

Your afternoon (share freely)

- **12:30 · Lunch.** Cece asked Emerson to serve Cece's chamomile in your heirloom blue teacup at the welcome tea, "to test it for the toast photo." Cece also showed the table a little amber bottle of heart drops.
- **2:55–3:02 ·** You and Blair unpacked the teacup in the tea room and set it on the side table.
- **3:05–3:25 ·** You and Blair waited at the dock, right beside the boathouse, and greeted the guests off the 3:15 ferry.
- **3:25–3:30 ·** You walked back up the garden path with Blair. **3:30 ·** Welcome tea.
- **4:15 ·** Cece went upstairs to rest. **5:45 ·** Cece did not answer the door.

Your privileges

1. **Guest of Honor Clues.** In each round the host hands you one gold-framed card (Evidence #4, #8 and #12). Read it aloud to everyone.
2. **Final Questions.** Before anyone votes, you may ask any three people one question each. They must answer about the evidence honestly.
3. **Something Blue.** After the vote, you open file 99 and read the reveal aloud.

Your goal

Find out who, how and why. Ask good questions, draw the quiet guests in and enjoy every minute: this party is for you. You can win Best Detective too.

PLAYING TIP

Jot down every time you hear on your Detective Notes. Someone's story will not match the clock. Save your toughest question for Final Questions.

Something Old

ROUND 1 · READ ONLY WHEN CALLED

Read only when the host starts Round 1.

When the host hands you **Evidence #4** (gold frame), stand up and read it aloud.

Share

- You and Blair unpacked the teacup at about 3:00. It was clean, empty and dry.
- You and Blair were together at the dock from 3:05 to 3:25.

Ask

- **Blair Ashdown:** “Did you know Cece before this weekend?”
- **Reese Calloway:** “Why did Cece try so hard to stop me hiring you?”

Your mission

Introduce two guests who have never met, and tell each one something you love about the other.

NOTES

✂ CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Something New

ROUND 2 · READ ONLY WHEN CALLED

Read only when the host starts Round 2.

When the host hands you **Evidence #8**, read it aloud.

Share

- From the dock you could see the boathouse the whole time. Nobody went near it between 3:05 and 3:25.

Ask

- **Emerson Pryce:** “Who asked you for a favor this afternoon, and when?”
- **Dakota Lane:** “You were under the tea room window. What did you see or hear?”

Your mission

Find the guest who traveled farthest to be here and ask them to tell the room one story about you.

NOTES

When the host hands you **Evidence #12**, read it aloud, slowly.

- Cece asked for your teacup at lunch, in front of everyone at the table. Anyone at lunch knew which cup Cece would drink from.

- **Finley Marsh:** “Where exactly were you between 3:10 and 3:27?”
- **Emerson Pryce:** “When did you last see the ‘Private Session’ sign, and where?”

Choose the three people for your Final Questions. Then gather everyone for one group photo before voting.

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